



Sarah Martinez

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Talent Development Specialist

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- 📋 SHRM-CP Certified
- 📋 PHR Certified

Certifications

- Unity Certified Expert: Programmer**
March 2022
Unity Technologies
- Unreal Engine 5 C++ Developer**
June 2023
Epic Games (Udemy)

Awards & Recognition

- Best Gameplay – Ludum Dare 48**
April 2021
Ludum Dare
Awarded for puzzle game 'Deeper and Deeper' which ranked in the top 5% overall among 3,000+ submissions
- Employee Excellence Award**
December 2021
Pixel Forge Interactive
Recognized for exceptional contributions to 'Starbound Odyssey' development and dedication to code quality

Languages

- English**
Native
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- Polish**
Conversational
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Passionate game developer with 5+ years of professional experience creating engaging gameplay systems and polished player experiences across multiple platforms. Specialized in Unity and Unreal Engine with strong expertise in C#, C++, and game design principles.

Online Presence

- LinkedIn**
@davidkowalski
- itch.io**
@dkowalski

Technical Skills

- </> Unity Engine**
Expert
C#, Editor Tools, Performance Profiling
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- { } Unreal Engine**
Advanced
C++, Blueprints, UE5 Features
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- 📦 Programming Languages**
Expert
C#, C++, Python, HLSL/GLSL
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- 🧠 Game AI**
Advanced
Behavior Trees, FSM, Pathfinding, Navigation
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Education

- University of Washington**
Bachelor of Science • 3.6 GPA
Computer Science
Seattle, WA • 2014 – 2018
Concentration in Game Development. Relevant Coursework: Game Engine Architecture, Computer Graphics, Artificial Intelligence, Physics Simulation, 3D Mathematics, Software Engineering, Data Structures & Algorithms

Professional Experience

- Cascade Studios** Seattle, WA
Senior Game Developer March 2022 – Present
 - Lead gameplay programmer on an unannounced AAA action-adventure title built in Unreal Engine 5 for PC and next-gen consoles
 - Architected and implemented core combat system including hit detection, combo mechanics, and enemy AI behavior trees serving 15+ enemy types
 - Developed custom editor tools in C++ that reduced level designer iteration time by 40% and improved workflow efficiency across the team
- Pixel Forge Interactive** Bellevue, WA
Game Developer June 2020 – February 2022
 - Core developer on 'Starbound Odyssey,' a sci-fi roguelike that achieved 500K+ sales on Steam with 'Very Positive' user reviews
 - Implemented procedural generation systems for level layouts, enemy encounters, and loot drops using Unity and C#
 - Designed and programmed player progression systems including skill trees, equipment upgrades, and meta-progression mechanics
 - Created robust save/load system supporting cloud saves and cross-platform play between PC and Nintendo Switch

Interests

Game Design

Mechanics, Level Design, Player Psychology

AI & Procedural Generation

PCG, Machine Learning, Emergent Gameplay

Indie Game Development

Solo Dev, Game Jams, Community

Technical Art

Shaders, VFX, Optimization

Publications & Talks

Optimizing Unity Games for Mobile: A Practical Guide

September 2021

Game Developer Magazine

Technical article covering mobile optimization techniques including draw call batching, LOD systems, and memory management

Building Modular Dialogue Systems

May 2022

Seattle Indie Game Developers Meetup

Presented talk on designing flexible dialogue systems for narrative games, attended by 60+ local developers

Notable Projects

Echoes of the Void (Indie Game)

2023 – Present

Solo developer for a narrative-driven 2D platformer built in Unity. Features custom dialogue system, branching story paths, and atmospheric pixel art. Currently in development with demo released on itch.io garnering 5K+ downloads and positive community feedback. Planned Steam release Q2 2025.

View on itch.io

Open Source: Unity Dialogue Framework

2021 – 2023

Created and maintain an open-source dialogue system for Unity with visual node-based editor, localization support, and voice acting integration. Project has 800+ GitHub stars and is actively used by indie developers worldwide. Includes comprehensive documentation and example projects.

View on GitHub

Game Jam Participation

2019 – Present

Regular participant in Ludum Dare and Global Game Jam events. Created 12+ game prototypes exploring experimental mechanics and art styles. Won 'Best Gameplay' award at Ludum Dare 48 with puzzle game 'Deeper and Deeper' that ranked in top 5% overall.

Community Involvement

Seattle Indies

2020 – Present

Seattle, WA

Active member of local indie game development community. Organize monthly game showcases and provide mentorship to aspiring game developers through code reviews and technical guidance.

Code.org Game Development Workshops

2021 – Present

Seattle, WA

Volunteer instructor teaching basic game programming concepts to middle school students. Led 8+ workshops introducing Unity fundamentals and game design principles.

References

Available upon request